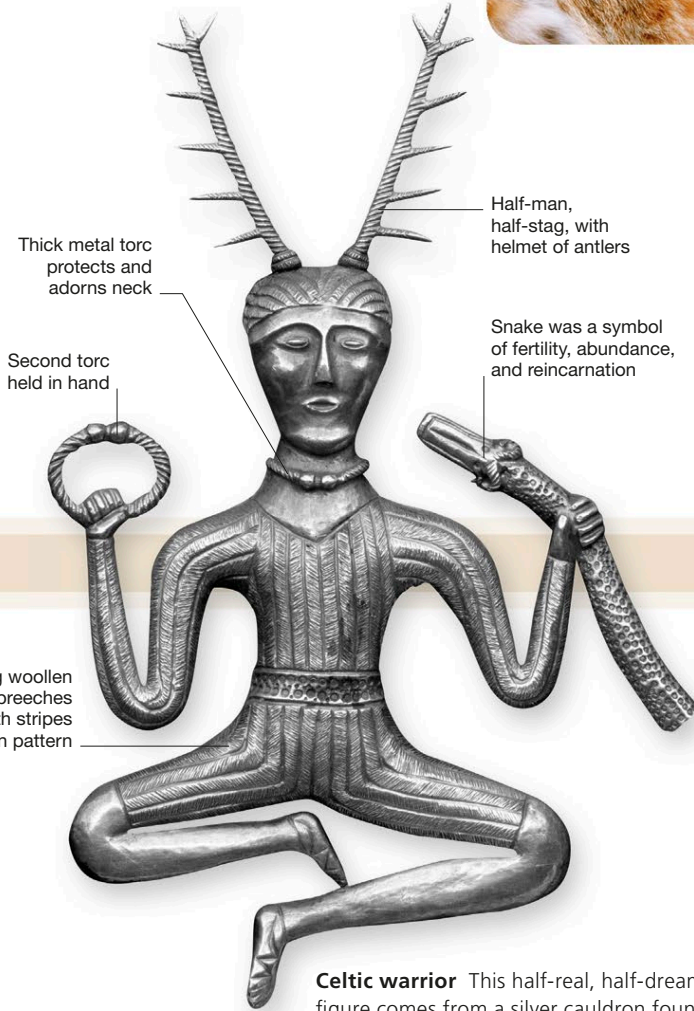




Symbolic weaponry Armour and weaponry, such as the shield and crest borne here by the Greek goddess Athena, c.490BCE, were sometimes purely symbolic. The figure is from the Temple of Aphaia on the island of Aegina.



Celtic warrior This half-real, half-dream figure comes from a silver cauldron found in a peat bog in Gundestrup, Jutland, Denmark, 150–0BCE. It was probably made in Celtic Romania.

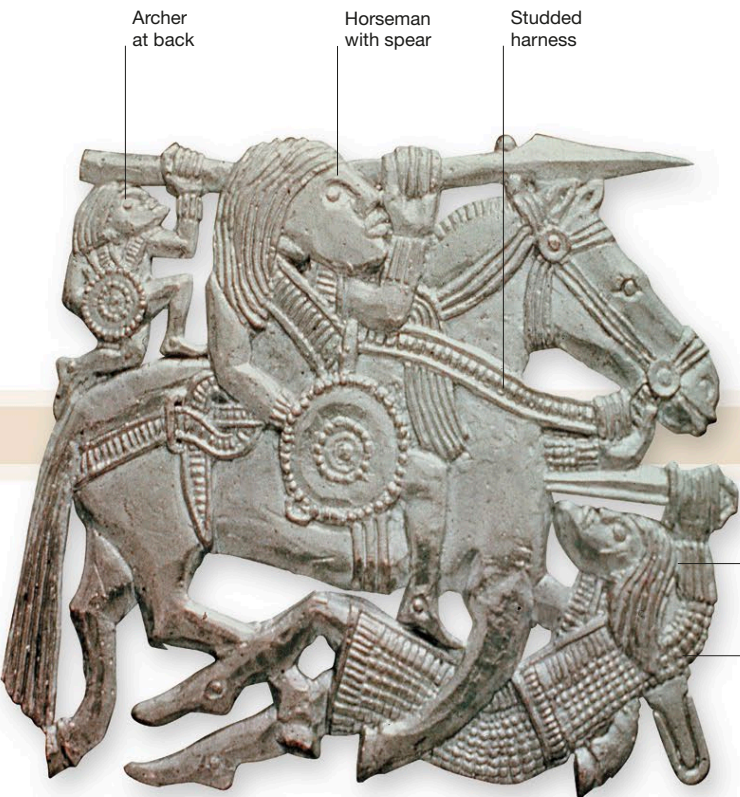
ARMOUR



Apart from the helmet, the cuirass was one of the most protective elements of a suit of armour. It covered the front of the torso, and was usually connected to a back piece for all-round protection. The so-called muscle or heroic cuirass of the classical world was cast to the wearer's body, and was designed to mimic an idealized human physique. Greek and Roman art often depicts generals and emperors wearing the heroic cuirass, but real soldiers would have used much simpler armour in battle.



Etruscan-Corinthian warrior Painted on an alabastron (perfume bottle) probably made in Etruria (now Tuscany) in the 6th century BCE, the soldier has some protective wear but mainly relies on his shield.



Anglo-Saxon ranks This helmet fragment from the 7th-century CE Sutton Hoo burial site in Suffolk, east England, shows different ranks of soldiers. The men wear protective clothing but no helmets over their long, flowing hair.



Scottish soldier This early medieval carving from a grave slab in the West Highlands of Scotland shows a man dressed in a long, padded leather garment known as a *cotun*, which gave reasonable protection in battle.